

Seagrass Stories: University Seminar

What does it take to bring an underwater meadow back to life?

Audience	University (undergraduate)	Duration	90 minutes
Format	Seminar, groups of 3 to 4	Your picks	Changi Point video; Map the chain

Learning goals

- Explain why seagrass meadows matter for marine life, carbon storage and coastlines.
- Analyse how human choices on land lead to changes in a seagrass meadow over time.
- Evaluate what counts as strong evidence that a restoration effort is working.
- Write a testable research question about a local seagrass site.

Before class (pre-reading, about 20 min)

- UNEP: Seagrass meadows. [unep.org/topics/ocean-seas-and-coasts/blue-ecosystems/seagrass-meadows](https://www.unep.org/topics/ocean-seas-and-coasts/blue-ecosystems/seagrass-meadows)
- Seagrass-Watch: Why seagrass matters. seagrasswatch.org/seagrassimportance

Ask students to note one fact that surprised them and one question they still have.

Lesson timeline

Time	Stage	Activity	Resource
0 to 10	Start here	Open with the driving question. Students share their pre-reading surprises and questions.	Driving question
10 to 20	Explore	Watch the scientist's story, then discuss what restoration work actually involves.	Video: The Scientist Bringing Seagrass to Life
20 to 30	Explore	Watch the Changi Point video. Groups use See, Think, Wonder to record observations.	Video: Changi Point (your pick)
30 to 45	Investigate	Groups play the Seagrass Stories game and note each restoration decision and its result.	Seagrass Stories game
45 to 55	Investigate	Debrief: which decisions mattered most, what took longest, and what showed recovery?	Investigate prompts
55 to 75	Create	Groups map a causal chain (choice, consequence, habitat response, change over time), then turn it into one research question.	Map the chain (your pick, adapted)
75 to 85	Reflect	Individual written reflection: what would convince you a meadow has truly recovered?	Reflect prompts
85 to 90	Wrap up	Share two research questions. Assign the quiz for after class.	Quiz link

Assessment

- **Quiz:** 6 questions (5 multiple choice, 1 short answer), shared as an online quiz link. Moves from recall to evaluation.

- **Research question:** each group submits one testable question naming a cause, an effect, a place and a timeframe.

Example: How does water clarity affect seagrass shoot density at a local site over 12 months?

Materials

Projector and speakers, devices for the game (one per group), sticky notes and pens, the educator guide.

Facilitation notes

- Keep the game debrief focused on evidence and timescales, not on winning.
- Push groups to make each link in the causal chain specific to a real place.
- If time is short, move the reflection to homework and keep the research question in class.

This is a mock lesson plan created for a prototype demonstration. Content will be reviewed by OceanX Education before release.